Course Outline

Course Title: Marketing Research		
Credits: 3	**Area: Marketing**	**Course Code:**
Instructor: Prof. Amar Saxena	**Email: AmarSaxena@gmail.com**	
Batch: MBA 2025-27		

Course Description:

Marketing Research is an applied area of marketing management, which deals with the critical field of understanding markets and customers. Such understanding is integral to the field of marketing, as it provides the guiding principle to decision making in the market. Actionable insights are key to the success of any marketing activity. This course will provide students with an introductory experience to the concepts, tools, and techniques of marketing research.

Course Objectives:

The key goal of this course is to provide students the essential knowledge of how to conduct marketing research. It aims to provide students an orientation to research methods, issues related to conducting marketing research, data analysis, and methods of evaluation related to marketing.

Learning Outcomes:

1. Appreciate the need for market research in effective marketing management.
2. Display problem analysis skills and an ability to translate a management problem into a feasible research question.
3. Demonstrate good knowledge of concepts and methods of marketing research.
4. Identify, plan and execute an efficient research design to address these questions.
5. Identify instruments, methods, and sources to collect data from the market.
6. Execute appropriate data analysis to arrive at the solution.
7. Be able to interpret the data and generate insights.

Pre-requisite course(s), if any:

An orientation to the Quantitative Techniques is recommended – but not mandatory.

Pedagogy:

Classroom Lectures, Group discussions, Hands-on exercises, Practical assignments and Guest Lecture.

Prescribed Textbook:

Naresh K. Malhotra and Satyabhushan Dash. (2015). *Marketing Research: An Applied Orientation*. 7th ed. Pearson Education Ltd.

Reference Books:

1. Business Research Methods. Donald Cooper, Pamela Schindler, JK Sharma. 11th Edition. McGraw Hill Education.
2. Business Research Methods. Zikmund Babin Carr and Grifin. 9th Edition. Cengage.

Attendance Policy:

In line with the HSB guidelines

Database / Software requirements (if applicable):

Students will be required to work on SPSS. Instructor will share a document that details getting started with the software.

Course Evaluation:

Sl. No.	Component	Nature	Weight (%)	Description
1.	Class Participation	Individual	10%	Factors: Class preparation, Attendance and Relevant participation in class discussions.
2.	Assignment	Group	10%	On Module 1.
2.	Quizzes	Individual	20%	2 quizzes. Both on Module 2.
4.	Group Project	Group	30%	3 sub-components
5.	End Term Exam	Individual	30%	

Session wise Details: (topics, cases and readings)

Session	Topic	Book Chapter	Case/ Reading
1.	Appreciating Marketing Research	Chap 1	Handouts
Module 1 – The Research Process			
2.	Problem Identification	Chap 2	Case: GEF India Pvt Ltd - Jan2011 - Defining the MR Problem Reading: Are You Solving the Right Problem
3.	From Marketing Problem to Research Objectives.	Chap 2	
4.	Converting Research Objective into Information Areas	Chap 2	
5.	Introduction to Research Design	Chap 3	
6.	Research Design – 1 Qualitative Data & Secondary Data	Chaps 4 & 5	Case: Fruitzone India Limited A
7.	Research Design – 2 Observation. Projective Techniques. Causal Research.	Chaps 5-6-7	
8.	Research Design – 3. Descriptive. Primary Quantitative Data	Chap 6	
9.	Measurement & Scaling	Chaps 8 & 9	Case: Fruitzone India Limited B
10.	Instruments	Chap 10	Reading: Questionnaire Design and Development
Module 2 – Analysis of Data			
11.	Understanding Your Data & Hypothesis Testing	Chap 15	Case: Data-Enabled Insights from Sericulture: Jayalaxmi Agro Tech
12.	Analysis of Variance and Covariance	Chap 16	
13.	Correlation and Regression	Chap 17	
14.	Finding the group membership. Discriminant Analysis	Chap 18	Case: Shiva Dhaba
15.	Classifying variables based on underlying associations. Factor Analysis.	Chap 19	
16.	Classifying respondents on homogeneity (Segmentation). Cluster Analysis.	Chap 20	
17.	Mapping customer perceptions and preferences. Multi-Dimensional scaling (MDS)	Chap 21	

18.	Identify relative preference/ importance or segmentation. Conjoint Analysis	Chap 21	Fidelity Incorporated - Pricing the Fidelity Blue Chip Growth Fund
Module 3 – Overall marketing research process			
19.	Synthesis of Learnings		Case: Blue Mountain Resorts Limited: The Night Skiing Decision
20.	Marketing Research in Practice		Handouts

Expectation from Students
For each class, it is expected that students will read the textbook chapter, the case and the prescribed reading.

Class Participation:
Class participation marks will depend on attendance, participation in class in terms of asking interesting question, examples, answering in-class questions etc. Displaying that the prescribed reading has been done will be rewarded.

Assignment:
There will be one assignment in the course – on module 1. You will get around a week to work on the assignment.

Research Project:
The primary purpose of this research project is a practical application of learnings in the course. It will involve designing the study, preparing and testing the questionnaire, collecting the data, completing the analysis – and then present the findings.
Details of the research project will be shared separately.